

New MacBook Pros this week

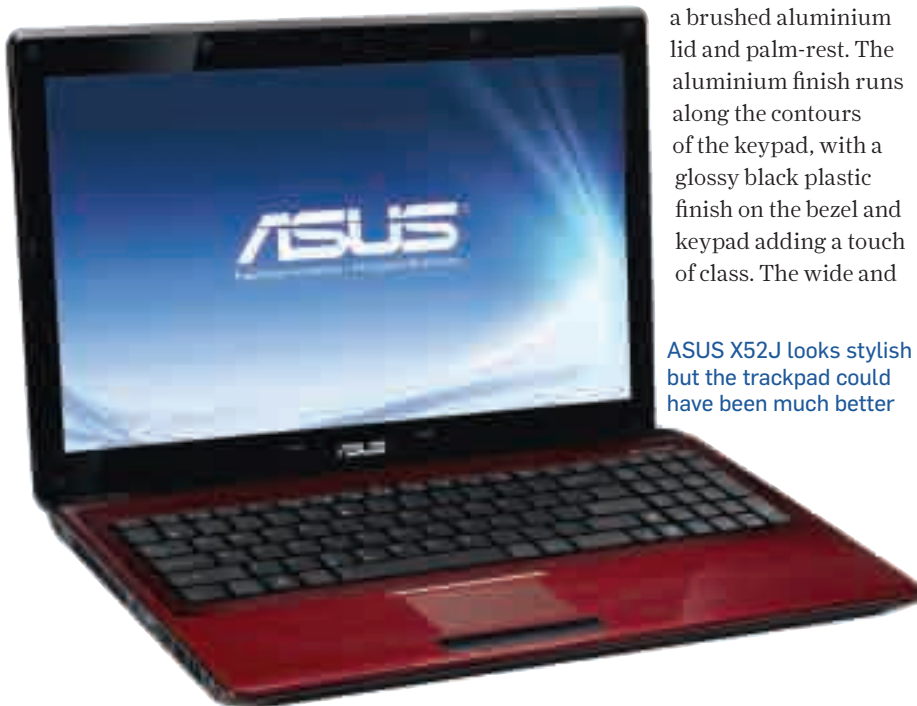
We're expecting new MacBook Pros from Apple. Rumours point to new Intel processors and platforms and a GPU refresh as well

Intel Medfield SoC

Intel is trying hard to break into the cellular SoC domain and their Atom-based Medfield SoC is now undergoing sampling

Notebook test

Acer's Aspire 4820T is part of their Timeline series. It is as close to a portable notebook as the entrants in this comparison get, weighing in at 2.07



ASUS X52J looks stylish but the trackpad could have been much better

kilograms. Although not as attractive or as sleek as some of the earlier Timeline models we tested in 2009, this notebook is reasonably sleek. It has a brushed aluminium lid and palm-rest. The aluminium finish runs along the contours of the keypad, with a glossy black plastic finish on the bezel and keypad adding a touch of class. The wide and

seamless touch-pad is a dark shade of grey, giving it a nice contrast against the lighter grey shades on the palm-rest. The palm-rest includes three LED indicators representing the display on, power on and Wi-Fi on/off status from left to right.

The other two notebooks that had 14-inch displays were the Acer Aspire 4738 and the Zenith Uranium. The former has a nice matte finish that is smudge-immune. The lid has a patterned design on it and the chocolate colour is a nice touch. Acer has been following the concept of using large keys that are flat and lack bevelling and larger gaps found on other keypads. They call this design a floating keypad and from what we've seen these floating keypads are really comfortable and offer quick, precise typing. The 4738 is no exception – typing is a pleasure. The notebook is pretty well constructed.

The Zenith Uranium has a black, brushed metal finish on the lid. The inner body is plastic and looks cheap, especially since we expected the goodies

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